dazed; there was no point in arguing. I called Polk. The meeting took place, without the Palestinian participant.

A few months later, in October 1973, in spite of accepting in principle Kissinger's idea of having Egyptian sovereignty over the Sinai while allowing Israel to be in control of its security in this region, Golda Meir's narrow-mindedness and stubbornness greatly contributed to what could have turned into an unredeemable military catastrophe for Israel. Over 2,200 soldiers paid with their lives. Two students of my small graduate seminar at Hebrew University, Shaul Shalev and Avi Shmueli, were among those killed.

Today, over 100,000 people demonstrated against the judicial reform in Tel Aviv and all over the country.

Sunday, February 19

The government is supposed to vote on the establishment of the Ministry of Settlement and National Projects under Minister Orit Strook of the Religious Zionist Party, Smotrich's party. Minister of Defense Gallant opposed it, but the cabinet will supposedly vote its establishment nonetheless. This comes as the American Ambassador to Israel announced that President Biden had advised Netanyahu "to pump the brakes" on the legal reform. Not sure at all that it will help; the prime minister may well have lost control of the situation.

The US has managed to convince Israel to postpone its plans for new settlements and the Palestinians to drop any attempts at condemning Israel in international forums until August. Thus the Palestinian-sponsored complaint to the Security Council is postponed. This is quite an American achievement; the Smotriches and Ben-Gvirs are furious but they will not dare to act against the agreement. At least, let's hope so.